

Product Roadmap & Lifecycle Guide

Applicable Roles: PO, PM

Product Lifecycle Stages

1. Discovery - Validate problem/market fit
2. Definition - Define MVP and success criteria
3. Development - Build iteratively
4. Launch - Release and go-to-market
5. Growth - Scale and optimize
6. Maturity - Optimize for retention
7. Decline - Sunset or pivot

Roadmap Structure

Quarterly roadmap should include:

- Theme/Objective
- Key initiatives (3-5 per quarter)
- Expected outcomes and metrics
- Dependencies and risks
- Resource requirements

Prioritization Framework

Use RICE scoring:

R = Reach (how many users affected)

I = Impact (quantified benefit)

C = Confidence (how sure are we?)

E = Effort (engineering time)

Score = $(R \times I \times C) / E$

Stakeholder Communication

- Monthly roadmap review with stakeholders
- Bi-weekly sprint demos
- Weekly status email (bullet points)
- Immediate escalation for blockers
- Document all decisions and rationale